Streamlight Desert



Theme: Chaos and Strife In the boundless desert, the struggle for power and profit devours, like a sandstorm, every soul that tries to break free of fate. Water sources and trade routes are not only the lifeline on which the desert's people depend, but also the arena where power is fought over. Every grain of sand in the Streamlight Desert carries the people's devotion to the god Saimi. Yet the forked paths of faith have become kindling for the fires of war.



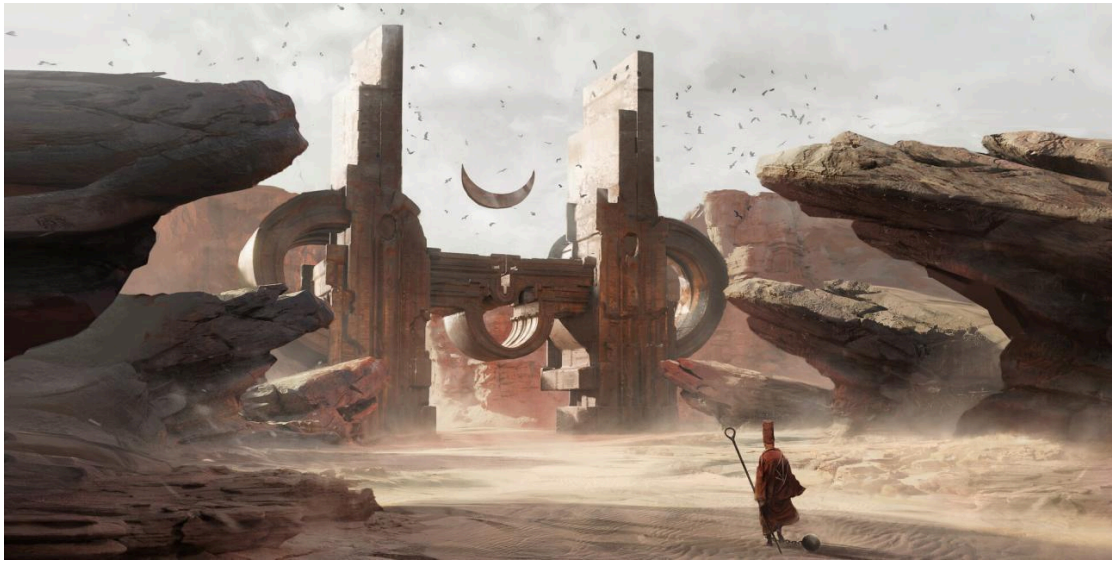
Geography and People: The Scarlet River and Streamlight Stone

The long Kesi Mountains stand like a natural rampart, cutting this scorching land off from the central continent and shielding the desert from the raging sandstorms of the Tamahe Desert to the southwest. Legend has it that the god Saimi once split the yellow sands and storms with divine power and drew the sea southward, forming the river of life that runs

through the heart of the desert: the Scarlet River. Oases dot both banks of the Scarlet River, and the tribes gather there. The desert's heartland, ravaged by sandstorms, remains forbidden ground where few have ever set foot.

The heart of the Streamlight Desert gives rise to a unique ore: streamlight stone. It is said that when Saimi split the desert, divine power rained down upon the land and, tempered by countless storms, set into fragments of streamlight. Whenever moonlight falls on them, the stones glow like a flowing, starry night, as if the earth were telling its ancient legends in the dark.

In the desert's chronicles, the Battle of Red Sands is sung from generation to generation. Besieged by the three great tribes, the Yake tribe stood on the brink of annihilation, until their priestess Haeti raised a staff of streamlight stone and summoned a colossal sandstorm that blotted out the sky. Terrified by this omen and believing they had offended the gods, the three tribes withdrew without a fight. After the Battle of Red Sands, Haeti was revered as the Oracle of Streamlight, and under her protection the Yake grew into the mightiest tribe in the Streamlight Desert.



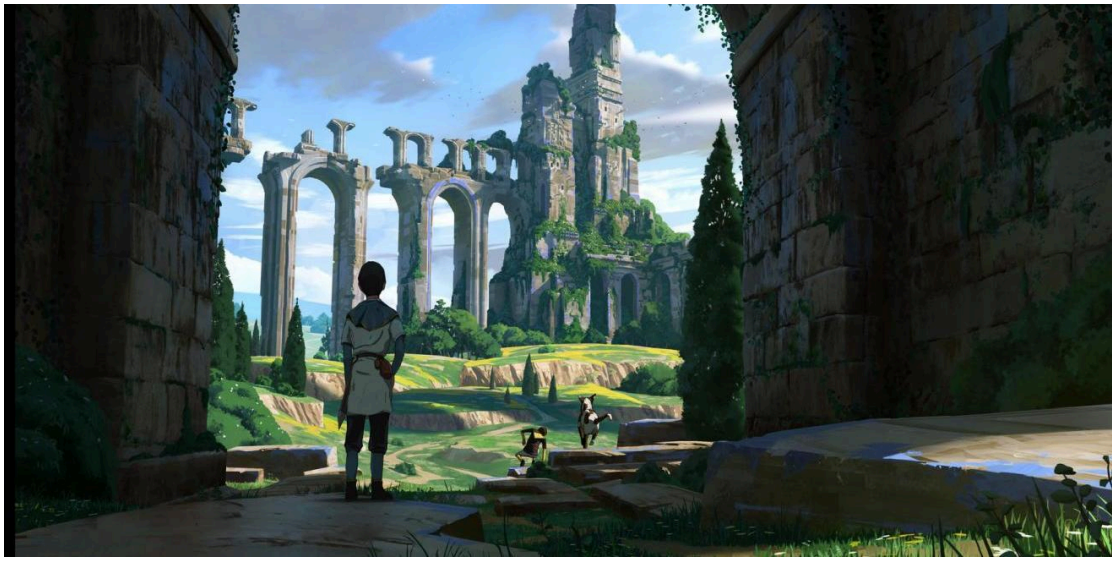
Customs and Culture: The Martial Tradition and the Scavengers

A martial tradition thrives undiminished in every tribe. Each battle is not only a contest of strength and skill but also a devout offering to Saimi. Besides the stern chieftains and priests, the shaman-healers who hold the arts of saving lives and the smiths who forge weapons are held in high esteem: they embody the strength and continuity of the tribe and are its indispensable pillars.

Those who live apart in the desert are called Scavengers. They leave the tribes and wander the desert alone, yet they can read the oracles of Saimi carved on the desert's ancient steles. Among the desolate ruins of the distant past, they search for the relics Saimi left behind, as if pursuing some unknown destiny. It is said that the very first Scavenger was Haeti, the Yake priestess once called the Oracle. According to legend, Haeti had a fierce quarrel with the former Yake chieftain. That night, beneath dimmed stars, she walked alone into the desert with her streamlight staff and vanished into the wind and sand. Ever since, the Yake have regarded Haeti as a traitor, and the tribe's priesthood has stood vacant.

Most tribes believe that Saimi stands for the natural law that the strong prey on the weak: only the strong can survive in this harsh desert. Yet a few hold fast to the belief that what Saimi truly embodies is life that endures. When the tribes, scattered like grains of sand, answer Saimi's call and become one, strife will at last fade away, and the desert will no longer be a deadly wasteland ruled by vultures and vipers, but the Eternal Oasis of prophecy.

The Tower in the Lake



Theme: The Lake Goddess's Sigh

The wakes of cargo ships cut through the still moonlight on the mirror-like lake, and the roar of machinery startles the waterbirds that nest there. People's eyes are fixed on the rich profits promised by the Merchant Guild Alliance, and a blind faith in money and power has gradually replaced the old beliefs. The goddess's weeping in the high tower of

old now seems no more than an echo of history. Through layer upon layer of power games, class and status have been divided and defined anew.

When a devout follower of the Lake Goddess eagerly told the Guild that he had found the hero of legend, and that the Tower in the Lake could at last be opened to free the goddess from a thousand years of imprisonment, the official reply from the Guild's secretary read: "Such a rash undertaking could cause unforeseeable economic losses and safety risks to the shipping industry and to the livelihoods of residents. Following careful assessment by the Guild, we regret to inform you that your proposal has been rejected and will not be carried out."



Geography and People: The Goddess's Slumber and the Guild's Rule

On the tranquil shore of Snow Egret Lake in the northeast, the shadow of a towering spire lies reflected in the lake's silver sheen. Legend has it that this tower is where Lutie, the Lake Goddess, slumbers, guarding the mystery and peace of these waters. Along the waterways to the southwest, the outline of a town gradually unfolds, where prosperity and bustle intertwine. The crisscrossing waterways not only bring the Tower in the Lake a rich shipping trade but have also honed the craft of shipbuilding to ever greater refinement.

The Merchant Guild Alliance holds a firm grip on the economic lifeline of Snow Egret Lake: every ship entering or leaving the Tower in the Lake must pay passage fees to the Shipping Guild. The Guild's power is like an invisible net cast over the whole town, and it

even carries decisive weight in its governance. Beneath the calm surface, however, undercurrents of conflicting interests run through the Guild itself.

Around Snow Egret Lake lies a precious ore called cobaltstone. Once smelted, the refined cobaltstone solution greatly reduces ships' fuel consumption, making it a treasure of the shipping trade. But the mining and smelting of cobaltstone are tightly monopolised by the Merchant Guild Alliance, and the high price of the solution puts it out of reach of many fleets. As a result, the smuggling of cobaltstone solution has quietly flourished across the lake, a hidden current beneath these waters.

Near the tower in the lake stands Ganbo Abbey. Legend says the music of Lutie's organ once echoed beneath the abbey's vaulted ceiling, its soaring melodies soothing the suffering of countless people. But with the goddess's fall and the westward migration of the population, the abbey's stained-glass windows have long been covered in moss and dust. Nowadays, when people come down with a headache or a fever, the first thing that comes to mind is booking an appointment at Blackfriars Hospital, owned by the Guild.



Customs and Culture: Requiem of the Snow Egret Flower

Legend has it that, amid the smoke of the Archon War, Lutie, goddess of Snow Egret Lake, fought a duel destined to last forever against Sors, a god who sought to destroy the Tower in the Lake. Although Lutie finally suppressed the evil power of Sors with her own divine strength, she could not escape his soul-eroding curse. To protect the people she loved so deeply, Lutie sealed herself inside the old high tower of Snow Egret Lake.

Before sealing herself away, Lutie gathered the last of her divine power into a key that symbolised hope and entrusted it to the Ganbo Church. She foretold that a hundred

years later, a hero from a distant land would come with the whispers of the river to open the tower and defeat Sors. Only at that moment would her soul be truly freed from its long imprisonment.

To console the goddess's soul, her followers keep an ancient tradition: they scatter snow egret petals into the river, hoping these petals, laden with devout prayers, will drift with the current to Snow Egret Lake. Over the years this tradition has gradually become the Guild's sailing ceremony. Before every Guild fleet sets sail, snow egret petals are scattered on the river to pray for smooth trading and a safe voyage. The delicate fragrance of the flowers seeps into the water and lingers along the trade routes of the Tower in the Lake, as if the afterglow of the Lake Goddess still clings fondly to her homeland.

Everlight Isle



Theme: Whispers of the Old God

Legend has it that Everlight Isle, home of the sirens, holds the sealed, vengeful spirit of Saiyi, the Old God of the Deep. The Siren Uprising has long since become buried history, yet the thick fog that never lifts from Everlight Isle and its endless storms seem to be the unappeasable hatred of Saiyi. When the seal is broken, the roar of the deep will shake heaven and earth like thunder, waking Leviathan, the slumbering great whale, which will devour every land in sight. Then the mortal world and the ocean will become one, and all things will return to eternal silence.



Geography and People: The Mirage Moon of the Sea

It is said that Everlight Isle was once firmly joined to the mainland. But Saiyi, the Old God of the Deep, raised towering waves in an attempt to seize the lands of the human world. The gods of the mainland brought down divine punishment from the heavens, severing Everlight Isle from the mainland and leaving it stranded alone in the vast sea. Yet the legends of Everlight Isle do not end there. Some say the isle is a mysterious land floating on the back of Leviathan, the great whale: a familiar of Saiyi that slumbers beneath Everlight Isle.

Legend has it that in Tideprayer Palace, which the sirens adorned with sea amber and mother-of-pearl, an ever-shining sea pearl once glittered. Its dreamlike light illuminated the whole sea, so that this siren sanctuary came to be called "the Mirage Moon of the Sea". But the sirens' former glory now lies buried in the ruins of Tideprayer Palace. Today, the remnants of Saiyi on Everlight Isle draw countless dangerous monsters, which lurk in this perilous land shrouded in fog and storms.

The people who live across the sea from Everlight Isle remember with gratitude the light that, in legend, once shone from Tideprayer Palace across the waves. They named the coast to the west of Everlight Isle "Wavehallow Cliff", in memory of the ancient legend of the Mirage Moon of the Sea.



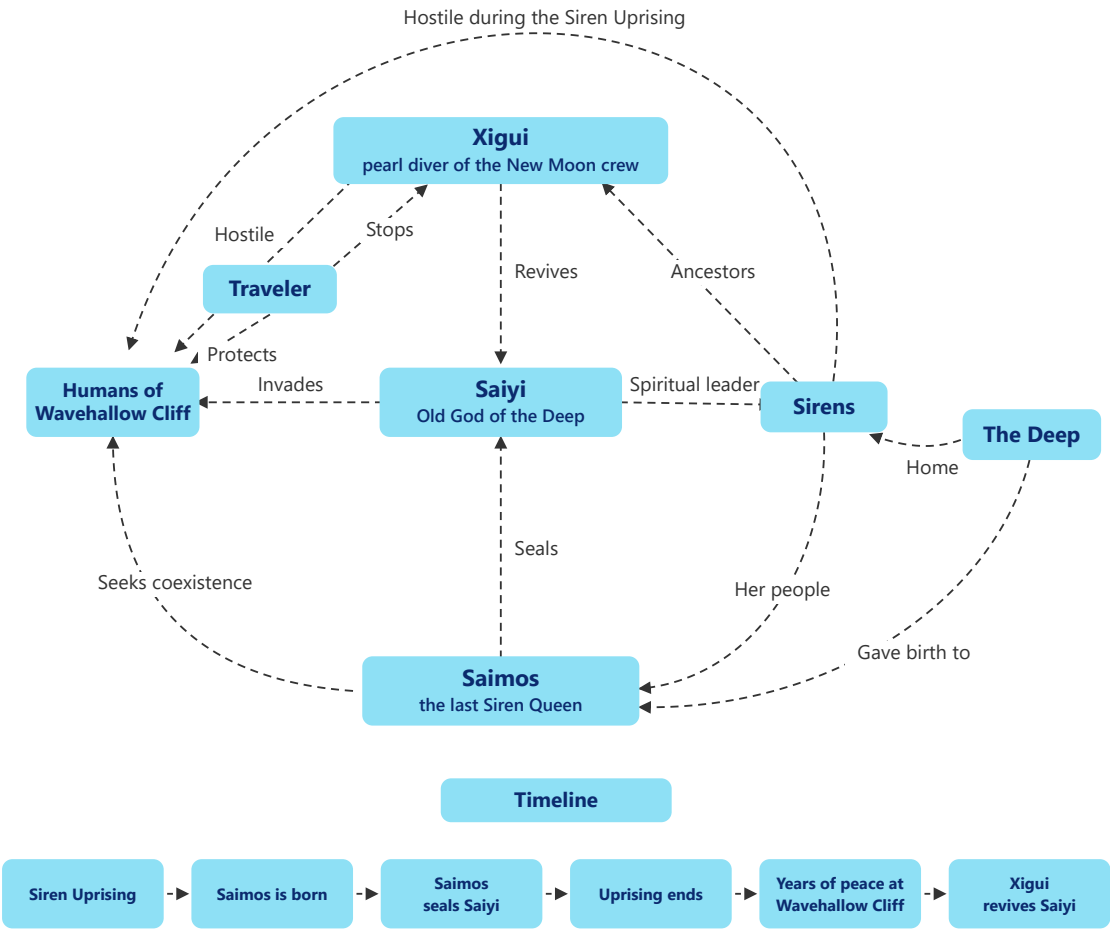
Customs and Culture: Pearl Divers and Sea Hunters

The whispers of the sea wind tell of the fates of those entangled with the deep.

Pearl divers can hear the whispers of the deep, and they gather precious seabright pearls from the depths around Everlight Isle that no ordinary person can reach. Ground into a medicinal powder, seabright pearl is known as "Siren's Kiss" and has miraculous healing powers: it is said to close a sword wound cut to the bone within three days. Although the merchants of Wavehallow Cliff grow rich on the divers' skills, behind their backs they scornfully call them "Remnants of the Deep". They depend on the divers yet stay wary of them, as if the divers' very existence were some uncontrollable danger.

Besides the pearl divers, the waters around Everlight Isle are home to sea hunters who make their living searching for siren treasure. Silver Halberd, once the most renowned sea-hunting crew, roamed these waters for many years, only to disband suddenly after returning from a hunt. Years later, a drunken old sailor finally revealed the secret: on that hunt, Silver Halberd found several pieces of sea amber of the finest quality. Believing they had struck it rich, they were caught in a ferocious storm on the voyage home. Just as they despaired of ending up in the bellies of fish, a flickering beam of light suddenly shone from Everlight Isle and guided them safely to land. Having escaped death, the sea hunters were convinced the sirens had protected them, so they returned the sea amber to the ocean, washed their hands of the trade, and never again coveted the treasures of the sirens.

Everlight Isle: Backstory



Setup and Rising Action

Through the Adventurers' Guild, the Traveler took on a commission from New Moon, a sea-hunting crew from Wavehallow Cliff: to find Xigui, one of the crew's pearl divers, who had gone missing near Everlight Isle. On many hunts Xigui had spoken of hearing whispers from the deep, so the New Moon crew were deeply worried about his disappearance, fearing that he had been drawn into some peril he could not escape.

Through mysterious whispers, Saiyi, the Old God of the Deep, had told Xigui that the pearl divers were descendants of the sirens, and that humans were the true culprits who had wiped out the sirens during the Siren Uprising. Beguiled by Saiyi, Xigui let a seed of vengeance take root in his heart. On one hunt, he slipped away from the New Moon crew and went alone to Everlight Isle, intending to break the seal in Tideprayer Palace, awaken the power of Saiyi, drown Wavehallow Cliff and take revenge on humankind.

Climax

In the long-abandoned Tideprayer Palace on Everlight Isle, Xigui succeeded in breaking the seal, releasing the power of Saiyi that had been sealed within the Everlight Candle. As the Old God's power awakened, storms and raging waves swept across the whole sea, and the fate of Wavehallow Cliff hung by a thread. To protect the people of Wavehallow Cliff, the Traveler fought a fierce battle against Xigui, who now wielded the power of the Old God of the Deep. At the decisive moment, the lingering will of Saimos, the Siren Queen, within the Everlight Candle sensed the Traveler's unwavering resolve to protect Wavehallow Cliff. Her will awakened, and she fought side by side with the Traveler against Xigui, who had been beguiled by Saiyi.

Resolution

After a hard-fought battle, the Traveler and Saimos defeated Xigui together. Then Saimos revealed her true identity and purpose. She was the last Siren Queen, yet not a creation of Saiyi: during the Siren Uprising, the deep had heard the sirens' cries of grief and given birth to her. Saimos understood that the endless conflict between humans and sirens stirred up by Saiyi would bring only boundless pain and destruction. To end this never-ending struggle, she chose to become the Everlight Candle, sacrificing herself to suppress the will of Saiyi to seize the land.

Saimos's sacrifice made Xigui realise that the true wish of the deep and of the sirens might not be vengeance and war, but peaceful coexistence with humans and a life that carries on. As the power of Saiyi was sealed once more, the storms over Everlight Isle gradually subsided, and the boundary between sea and land was restored. And in that moment, Xigui began to rethink the relationship between the deep and humankind.

Dialogue Event: Everlight Isle Backstory

[Xigui has broken the seal and gained the power of Saiyi, the Old God of the Deep, and the fate of Wavehallow Cliff hangs by a thread. Facing Xigui, now in the grip of the Old God's power, the Traveler resolutely takes up the fight. Amid roaring waves and clashing blades, the two of them speak.]

Traveler: Xigui, your friends... they're all waiting for you to come home.

(A flicker of hesitation crosses Xigui's face, but then the sea-blue siren totem on his brow flares bright, and several blades of water formed from the waves hurtle towards the Traveler at astonishing speed.)

Xigui: Home? I was born of the boundless deep and the cold moonlight. My home was never Wavehallow Cliff.

Traveler: Xigui, Saiyi's will has blinded you. Does all this hatred for humans really come from your own heart?

Xigui: I can't forget the contempt in those merchants' eyes when they called me a "Remnant of the Deep" behind my back. To them, I was nothing but a money tree. They looked at me like sharks smelling blood.

Traveler: It's true that some merchants are prejudiced. But the hunters of New Moon braved storms and pirate attacks to search for you with me. If they were only in it for profit too, why would they take such a risk for you?

Xigui: Friends? How laughable. The children of the deep need no charity from human feelings. They pity outcasts like me only to make themselves feel more important.

Traveler: You're clinging too hard to the Old God's will. You've misjudged their kindness.

Xigui: To carry out the Old God's will is the highest honour for the children of the deep. And you... you only see things from the human side.

(The Traveler swings his sword to deflect Xigui's water blades and levels the blade at Xigui, his voice resolute.)

Traveler: For the so-called will of the Old God, you're willing to sacrifice hundreds of innocent people at Wavehallow Cliff, and even drag your own friends down into the abyss with them?

Xigui: Humans fight for territory; we fight for the will of the Old God. We simply stand on different sides. It's like any debate: only the winner gets to define the "truth".

Xigui: Do you know what the sirens call that so-called "Siren Uprising"? We call it "the Sea's Lament"! It wasn't only humans who lost their homes. **Half of the blood that stained the land and sea red was siren blood!**

Traveler: That war left scars on humans and sirens alike that can never be erased. Why would you destroy, with your own hands, the peace that was so hard to win?

Xigui: Then why were the sirens doomed to die out, while humans became masters of this land? **Is this unjust fate what you call justice?**

(Water blades and sword-light collide fiercely, bursting into scattered Hydro particles. The Traveler's expression grows ever more anxious, but his voice remains sincere.)

Traveler: Tideprayer Palace and the history of the sirens were reduced to ruins in the war. But if sirens and humans rebuilt the palace together, the sirens' history might live on and become a heritage we share!

Xigui: Human voices dominate only because they drown out everyone who disagrees. The hypocrites' lies will be swallowed by the roar of the deep, and everything will return to the boundless sea, to its first stillness and vastness!

[The light of the Everlight Candle flares once more, and the power of Saimos, the Siren Queen, awakens within it. With Saimos's help, the Traveler finally defeats Xigui. After the battle, the three speak softly in the still sea breeze, as though time itself has stopped.]

Traveler: You sacrificed yourself to seal Saiyi.

Saimos: Saiyi's power was too great. Had I not done so, this land would never have known lasting peace.

Xigui: You are the Old God's own kin, yet you defied her will. Isn't... isn't that a betrayal of your people?

Saimos: Saiyi's will brings only endless strife.

(Xigui's voice trembles slightly; doubt and confusion he cannot hold back well up within him.)

Xigui: But the Old God created us in the boundless sea, and you hold the supreme authority she granted you. Why do you stand with humans instead of upholding the will of the deep?

Saimos: The blood of humans and sirens stained the sea red. The cries of seabirds were drowned out by the endless clash of arms, and the smoke of war hung day after day where sea meets sky. Is such a world truly what the sirens hoped for?

Xigui: But without you, without the Old God's guidance, what meaning does our existence have?

Saimos: That is a question worth pondering. Traveler, I'd like to know what your answer would be.

Traveler: To find my lost sibling, I've travelled through many nations with Paimon, and made many friends who treated me sincerely.

Paimon: And we ate lots of yummy food together!

(Saimos's gaze, gentle yet resolute, passes over the ruins of Tideprayer Palace to the sea, now returned to calm.)

Saimos: In that war, the sea carried too many siren tears. I felt their unease, their pain and their helplessness. They prayed for a world without war, and the deep answered their wish. And so I was born where moonlight meets the tide.

Traveler: You aren't Saiyi's creation. You came from the deep itself.

Paimon: The sirens' wishes came together, and that's how Saimos came to be.

Xigui: The sirens' wish... was coexistence... not conquest?

Saimos: **Precisely because a wish is the most fundamental power of all, it can cross hatred and division and bring about true change.**

(Saimos looks tenderly at the Traveler and Xigui. As the flame of the Everlight Candle is kindled once more, her figure slowly dissolves into a faint radiance in the dawn light where sea meets sky.)

Saimos: May the children of the deep no longer be bound by the obsessions and hatred of the past, but greet a new life of their own in a wider world. This is the wish of the deep, and my wish too.

Traveler: Saimos?

(No answer comes from the ruins of Tideprayer Palace. Only the sound of the tide remains, rolling on without end.)